

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 2-3 · with clues

Name _____

Date _____

Use the clues. Change **one letter** each step to make the word that matches the clue.

Ladder 1

C O O K

Start here

1

It has pages for you to read

2

A tall shoe for rain or snow

3

You put a sock on it

4

A strong building with walls to keep people safe

F O R M

Finish here

Ladder 2

M E E T

Start here

1

Food that comes from animals

2

Breakfast, lunch or dinner

3

A sea animal with flippers and whiskers

4

The opposite of buy

S E L F

Finish here

Ladder 3

H O R N

Start here

1

Yellow grains that grow on a cob

2

A piece of metal money

3

The part of your face under your mouth

4

A small piece broken off something

S H I P

Finish here

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C O O K

Start here

1 B O O K

It has pages for you to read

2 B O O T

A tall shoe for rain or snow

3 F O O T

You put a sock on it

4 F O R T

A strong building with walls to keep people safe

F O R M

Finish here

Ladder 2

M E E T

Start here

1 M E A T

Food that comes from animals

2 M E A L

Breakfast, lunch or dinner

3 S E A L

A sea animal with flippers and whiskers

4 S E L L

The opposite of buy

S E L F

Finish here

Ladder 3

H O R N

Start here

1 C O R N

Yellow grains that grow on a cob

2 C O I N

A piece of metal money

3 C H I N

The part of your face under your mouth

4 C H I P

A small piece broken off something

S H I P

Finish here